

The department has recently been notified by the National Fire Ant Eradication Program that a treatment product used to treat red imported fire ants on operations certified for export under the National Standard for Organic and Bio-Dynamic Produce contains two non-viable ingredients derived from genetically modified plants.

Treatment of organic and bio-dynamic operations has been temporarily halted by the National Fire Ant Eradication Program while it seeks suitable alternative treatment products. Treatment of non-organic operations is continuing.

For questions or more information, refer to the [National Fire Ant Eradication Program website](#).

The department is urgently seeking technical advice to determine requirements for treated operations that are certified for export under the National Standard for Organic and Bio-Dynamic Produce. Information and advice will be issued to the organic export sector accordingly.

All facilities that produce or prepare organic goods for export must be certified. This applies to:

- producers
- suppliers
- processors
- manufacturers
- storage facilities.

‘Organic goods’ means any goods that are labelled or described, or goods with ingredients that are labelled or described, as:

- organic
- bio-dynamic
- biological
- ecological
- other similar descriptions*

*This includes goods and/or ingredients that are described or labelled as ‘in conversion to organic or bio-dynamic’.

Find out more about [Australian export laws for organic products](#).

All importing country requirements relevant to the organic goods must be met. This applies to everyone involved in the export supply chain for these goods.

Prior to export:

- check our [Manual of Importing Country Requirements \(Micor\)](#)
- talk to the importing country authority
- check the organic export [market access advice notices webpage](#).

You can also talk to one of our [approved certifying bodies](#).

You must be certified organic/bio-dynamic even if you are already registered with us for your commodity.

The application for organic/bio-dynamic certification can be completed through one of our [approved certifying bodies](#).

The approved certifying body will provide advice on the processes for becoming certified organic/bio-dynamic. This will include inspecting your premises to make sure you comply with:

- the [National Standard for Organic and Bio-Dynamic Produce](#)
- the [Export Control \(Organic Goods\) Rules 2021](#)
- importing country requirements.

Be aware that the transition to full organic/bio-dynamic certification can take at least 3 years.

To export your own product (rather than sell to someone else to export), check [requirements for organic/bio-dynamic exporters](#).

Goods must be labelled to meet requirements under the [National Standard for Organic and Bio-dynamic Produce](#).

The label information for these goods must be:

- true and correct for that product
- verifiable (with no unsubstantiated health claims)

Translations for any information supplied in a foreign language must also be provided.

Descriptions on product labels that give the impression or imply the organic nature or organic certification of the product or its ingredients may also result in the product being considered an 'organic good' under the [Australian export laws for organic products](#).

Some examples of these descriptions are:

- organic
- certified organic
- grown on a certified organic farm
- made from organic products
- ingredients grown on a certified organic farm
- or other similar descriptions.

Product labels for organic goods must be authorised by your [approved certifying body](#).

You may also need to comply with other Australian export laws. This is separate to the requirements for organic or bio-dynamic goods.

Check export requirements for:

Make sure the details in your organic goods certificate match all other export certification.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/controlled-goods/organic-bio-dynamic/operators>